

PRE-SALES INTELLIGENCE BRIEF

Marriott

📅 28 May 2026

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🏢 COMPANY SNAPSHOT

1 REVENUE & MARGIN

- Last reported annual revenue: \$26.19 billion (Fiscal Year 2025).
- Operating margin: 15.81% (Fiscal Year 2025).
- Net margin: 9.93% (Fiscal Year 2025).

2 REVENUE TREND

Year	Revenue (in billions USD)	Operating Margin	Net Margin
2025	\$26.19	15.81%	9.93%
2024	\$25.10	12.55%	9.46%
2023	\$23.71	14.25%	13.00%
2022	\$20.77	14.99%	11.23%
2021	\$13.86	8.52%	9.52%

3 EMPLOYEES

- Total global headcount: 148,000 (Fiscal Year 2025). Other sources indicate 414,000 for 2025 and 418,000 for 2024.
- Break down by high-cost locations (US, UK, Germany, Australia, Canada): Not publicly available.

4 INDIA PRESENCE

- Marriott International has a significant presence and is rapidly expanding in India. The "Series by Marriott" brand, a collaboration with Concept Hospitality Private Limited (CHPL), launched in November 2025, has achieved 75 hotel signings and 50 property openings within six months. This expansion adds over 3,556 rooms to Marriott's portfolio across 43 cities in India, covering Tier 1, 2, and 3 markets, as well as resort destinations. Marriott aims to have 250 operating hotels in India with approximately 50,000 rooms by 2030.
- India GCC, delivery center, or R&D center headcount and location: Not publicly available.

5 RECENT NEWS

November 2025 - May 2026):

- (a) Product News:
 - In November 2025, Marriott International debuted "Series by Marriott" in India, a collection brand in partnership with Concept Hospitality Private Limited (CHPL). By May 2026, it had achieved 75 hotel signings and 50 openings, adding over 3,556 rooms across 43 cities.
 - In 2025, Marriott expanded its brand portfolio with the acquisition of citizenM, adding over 35 hotels and nearly 9,000 rooms to its system. The company also introduced Outdoor Collection by Marriott Bonvoy and accelerated its presence in the midscale segment through brands like City Express by Marriott, StudioRes, and Four Points Flex by Sheraton.
- (b) Company News:
 - Marriott International reported its fourth quarter and full year 2025 results on February 10, 2026, highlighting excellent performance, over 4.3% net room growth, and significant capital returns to shareholders.
 - On May 6, 2026, Marriott International reported its Q1 2026 revenue of \$6.65 billion, a 6.24% increase year-over-year.

- Marriott International stockholders reelected the board in May 2026.

6

M&A ACTIVITY

May 2024 - May 2026):

- In 2025, Marriott acquired citizenM, adding over 35 hotels and nearly 9,000 rooms to its system.

7

OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE

- Marriott International is a publicly traded company.
- Ticker: MAR.
- Exchange: NASDAQ.
- The ownership structure is diverse, with institutional investors holding a dominant role, accounting for approximately 65% as of July 2025, and over 80% of the public float as of 2024-2025. Members of the Marriott family are significant insider shareholders.

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KEY COMPETITORS

- Hilton Worldwide
- Hyatt Hotels Corporation
- InterContinental Hotels Group (IHG)
- Accor
- Wyndham Hotels & Resorts

STRATEGIC DIRECTION

Marriott's corporate strategy for the next 12-18 months is heavily focused on global expansion, technological transformation with a strong emphasis on AI, and enhancing guest experience across its diverse brand portfolio.

1

CORPORATE VISION & DIRECTION

Marriott's leadership, under President and CEO Anthony Capuano, is steering the company towards "Enterprise Transformation," balancing growth with strategic investment and an evolving consumer landscape. Capuano emphasizes that "technology modernization is becoming foundational to Marriott's long-term growth strategy". The company aims to accelerate its net unit growth, leveraging its global footprint and a proactive conversions strategy, particularly as new construction faces challenges.

Key aspects of their vision include:

- **Continued Global Expansion:** Marriott aims for a net rooms growth between 4.5% to 5% in 2026, building on a record pipeline of 610,000 rooms at the end of 2025. This includes significant growth in the luxury segment with nearly 35 new luxury hotel openings planned for 2026 across brands like St. Regis, Ritz-Carlton, W Hotels, and JW Marriott. Expansion is also notable in midscale offerings, such as the City Express by Marriott brand, particularly in regions like the Caribbean and Latin America (CALA) and EMEA.
- **Elevating the Loyalty Program:** Marriott Bonvoy remains a strategic asset, with efforts to enhance its value for members through credit card offerings, loyalty partnerships, and unique experiences. The program grew to nearly 271 million members at year-end 2025, adding 43 million new members.
- **Addressing Evolving Traveler Expectations:** Marriott is focusing on experiences that balance personal well-being with connection and discovery, particularly within its luxury portfolio. Tina Edmundson, President of Luxury at Marriott International, noted, "Luxury has evolved from being about the things you have to how you feel". This includes culturally enriching experiences, wellness programs, and offerings designed for multi-generational and group travel.
- **Financial Performance:** For 2026, Marriott expects global RevPAR growth of 1.5% to 2.5%. Adjusted EBITDA is projected to increase between 8% to 10%, reaching roughly \$5.8 billion to \$5.9 billion, and adjusted diluted EPS growth is expected between 13% to 15%. The company also plans to return over \$4.4 billion to shareholders in 2026 through dividends and buybacks.

2

BIG STRATEGIC INITIATIVES

Marriott's strategic initiatives are largely intertwined with its digital and technology transformation, aiming for efficiency, enhanced guest experience, and sustainable growth.

- **Technology Transformation & Replatforming (Project Catalyst):** Marriott has committed over \$1.1 billion in investment spending in 2026, with more than one-third dedicated to digital and technology transformation. The core of this initiative is "Project Catalyst," a multi-year effort to replatform its three most critical technology platforms: the property management system, central reservations infrastructure, and loyalty platform. These systems have moved from development into deployment, with rollouts planned for a "meaningful number" of hotels in 2026. This transformation aims to move away from fragmented legacy systems to cloud-native environments, enabling unified guest data and real-time analytics.
- **Luxury Expansion:** Marriott is focused on strengthening its global presence in the luxury segment with nearly 35 new luxury hotel openings planned in 2026. This expansion emphasizes immersive, wellness-driven, and culturally enriching experiences in high-demand destinations such as Japan, India, and the UAE.
- **Midscale Segment Growth:** The company has seen "extraordinary growth" in the midscale segment since entering it in 2023, with a strategic focus on regionally resonant brands like City Express by Marriott and Four Points Express by Sheraton.
- **Sustainability Mandates (Serve 360):** Marriott's "Serve 360" platform guides its sustainability and social impact goals for 2026-2030. Key environmental targets include reducing carbon intensity by 30%, water intensity by 15%, and waste to landfill by 45% (with a 50% cut in food waste) by 2025. It also aims for 30% renewable electricity across its portfolio by 2025 and has set an ambitious target of achieving net-zero emissions across its entire value chain by 2050. Marriott will also set a single-use plastic reduction goal by the end of 2025 and disclose a baseline footprint of single-use plastics starting in 2026. Social impact

goals include contributing 15 million hours of volunteer service globally and completing 7.5 million training courses on welcoming all.

3

TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY

Marriott's technology strategy is centered on building an AI-ready ecosystem through cloud-native platforms, unified data, and strategic vendor relationships.

- **AI Adoption Stance:** Marriott is "actively investing" in AI, shifting from experimentation and piloting in 2025 to scaling AI initiatives in 2026. CIO Naveen Manga states that 2026 is "a year for scale" for AI. CEO Anthony Capuano views AI as a "long-term opportunity to redefine how hotels acquire, serve, and retain guests". The company is taking a "disciplined approach" to unlock value for guests, associates, and owners.
- **AI Use Cases:** Marriott is focusing on AI to improve guest experience through natural language search on its website and app, powered by OpenAI, and exploring agentic booking integrations with Google's AI Mode. They are also evaluating tools to assist front desk associates and building platforms for owners to gain streamlined insights into hotel operations. Operational AI tools are being used to improve labor scheduling and supply chain logistics to manage inflationary pressures.
- **"Agentic Mesh":** Marriott is developing an "agentic mesh," a shared intelligence layer that will allow AI capabilities to be reused across operations, marketing, customer service, and revenue optimization.
- **Data as a Foundation:** Drew Pinto, Executive Vice President and Chief Revenue and Technology Officer, emphasizes that "problems that we think are technology problems are actually data problems". This drives a renewed focus on data infrastructure and governance to ensure clean, unified, and accessible data for AI models.
- **Cloud Migration & Platform Consolidation:** Marriott is undergoing a multi-year digital transformation to rearchitect its entire technology backbone around AI. This involves migrating core platforms—property management, central reservations, and loyalty systems—to cloud-native environments. The primary drivers for this migration are to improve guest experience, enable agility and innovation, and move away from data center constraints. The company has invested heavily, with \$1.8 billion in capital and technology expenditures since 2023, and another \$1.1 billion planned for 2026, with about 35% allocated to replatforming efforts.
- **Vendor Relationships:** Marriott is collaborating with technology leaders like OpenAI and Google for AI-powered features. The company has also selected Agilysys as a property management solution provider for its U.S. and Canada luxury, premium, and select-service properties. Furthermore, Marriott signed a Master Service Agreement with Shiji in 2023 to expand the deployment of Infrasy's Cloud POS across multiple regions and selected SevenRooms as its preferred restaurant technology partner. In 2023, Marriott also went live with CXone to consolidate its customer service tech stack across 20 international contact centers.
- **Build vs. Buy Signals:** Marriott's approach suggests a "build for differentiation, buy for commodity" philosophy. They are building internal "agentic mesh" and AI chassis to power various use cases, while also partnering with external vendors for specialized solutions and core infrastructure needs like cloud platforms (e.g., AWS). Drew Pinto stated that the technology Marriott has built will "unlock the full potential of AI".



LEADERSHIP & ORG

- CEO: Anthony Capuano
- Tenure: Appointed CEO in February 2021.
- Background: Joined Marriott in 1995. Prior to becoming CEO, he served as Group President, Global Development, Design and Operations Services, leading strategic unit growth across Marriott's brands and overseeing global design and operating standards.
- CFO: Jen Mason (effective April 1, 2026)
- Tenure: Will assume the CFO role on April 1, 2026.
- Background: A 33-year Marriott veteran, Mason currently serves as Global Officer, Treasurer and Risk Management. She previously held roles including CFO for the U.S. & Canada division.
- CTO/CDO: Naveen Manga (Global Chief Technology Officer)
- Tenure: Global Chief Technology Officer since August 2021.
- Background: Has over 20 years of business technology leadership experience across various industries, including travel and hospitality. At Marriott, he is responsible for global technology strategy, innovation, and transformation.
- COO: Marriott International does not currently list a single global Chief Operating Officer. The functions typically associated with a COO may be integrated within the CEO's responsibilities or distributed among group presidents managing various regions and business units.

Several key leadership changes have been announced recently, indicating strategic shifts and upcoming transitions:

- CFO Retirement: Leeny Oberg, the current Chief Financial Officer and Executive Vice President of Development, is set to retire on March 31, 2026, after a 26-year career with Marriott, including 10 years as CFO. (Timing Signal)
- New CFO Appointment: Jen Mason will succeed Leeny Oberg as Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer, effective April 1, 2026. (Timing Signal)
- Retirements of Group Presidents: Liam Brown, Group President for the U.S. and Canada, and Brian King, President, Enterprise Transformation & Caribbean and Latin America (CALA), will step down from their roles at the end of March 2026 and retire from the company at the end of June 2026. (Timing Signal)
- New Regional Leadership Appointments (effective March 28, 2026):
- Satya Anand (previously President of Europe, Middle East and Africa - EMEA) will become Group President, U.S., Canada, and CALA, unifying these regions under a single leadership structure.
- Neal Jones (previously Chief Operating Officer for Europe and Africa and Global Leader Design Hotels) will be promoted to President, EMEA.
- Federico "Fede" Greppi (previously Chief Operating Officer for CALA) will become President of the CALA region.

These recent and upcoming transitions in the C-suite and regional leadership are significant timing signals, indicating a realignment of top management and a strategic focus on global expansion and unified regional structures.

- Marriott's technology strategy is largely centralized and global. The company is undergoing a multiyear technology transformation, led by Global CTO Naveen Manga, focusing on replatforming core systems (property management, central reservations, loyalty platform) into cloud-native environments.

- This initiative aims to create a "shared intelligence layer" to support AI across various functions (marketing, operations, customer service, revenue optimization) and ensure interoperability across its diverse brands and geographies. The explicit goal is to drive long-term business value through a unified global technology strategy.
- The recent restructuring of continent leadership, consolidating the U.S., Canada, and CALA regions under a single Group President, also suggests a move towards more centralized and streamlined operational oversight.

4

BOARD COMPOSITION

- Key Board Members: The Board of Directors includes J.W. Marriott Jr. (Executive Chairman), David S. Marriott (Chairman), and Anthony G. Capuano (CEO). Other notable members listed as of recent past include Debra L. Lee (Former Chairman and CEO of BET Networks), Frederick W. Smith (Chairman and CEO of FedEx, as of 2021), Eric Hippeau (Managing Partner at Lerer Hippeau), Margaret M. McCarthy (Former Executive Vice President at CVS Health Corporation), George Muñoz (Principal at Muñoz Investment Banking Group, LLC), Steven S Reinemund (Retired Chairman and CEO of PepsiCo, Inc.), Susan C. Schwab (Professor Emerita, University of Maryland), Isabella D. Goren (Former CFO, American Airlines, Inc.), Deborah Marriott Harrison (Global Cultural Ambassador Emeritus), and Horacio D. Rozanski (President and CEO, Booz Allen Hamilton Inc.).
- PE Representation: The available information does not explicitly state the presence of private equity (PE) representatives directly on Marriott International's Board of Directors. While William J. Shaw (a former Marriott International executive) serves on the board of The Carlyle Group Inc., this does not indicate Carlyle's direct representation on Marriott International's board.
- Notable Strategic Investors: Institutional investors hold a significant portion of Marriott International's stock. As of July 2025, institutional investors held approximately 65% of the company's shares. Top institutional shareholders include Vanguard Group Inc., BlackRock, Inc., and State Street Corp., collectively owning a substantial portion of the company's shares. Members of the Marriott family are also significant insider shareholders.



BUYING SIGNALS

1 FINANCIAL STRESS SIGNALS

Marriott International demonstrated strong financial performance in late 2025 and early 2026. The company exceeded expectations with strong RevPAR (Revenue Per Available Room) and fee growth in Q1 2026, raising its outlook for the U.S., Canada, and China. Full-year 2025 results showed increased revenue and net income compared to 2024. Adjusted EBITDA also saw significant growth in 2025.

Despite overall positive results, some areas indicate potential pressure points:

- **Margin Compression/Cost-cutting:** Marriott announced plans for an enterprise-wide initiative to enhance effectiveness and efficiency, targeting \$80-\$90 million in annual pre-tax general and administrative (G&A) cost reductions starting in 2025. This initiative also aims to deliver cost savings to owners and franchisees.
- **Market Weakness:** The forecast for 2026 room revenue growth is below Wall Street estimates, attributed to weak travel spending by low- and middle-income households in the United States. U.S. & Canada RevPAR experienced a slight decline or remained flat in Q3 and Q4 2025, partially due to an extended government shutdown affecting the business transient segment.
- **Related Entity Performance:** Marriott Vacations Worldwide (MVW), a separate entity, reported a 16% decline in adjusted EBITDA and a 2% decrease in contract sales in Q1 2026. MVW is undergoing strategic restructuring and implementing "meaningful changes" to address sales softness and improve profitability.

2 TECHNOLOGY PAIN SIGNALS

Marriott is actively pursuing significant technology modernization and adoption, indicating a focus on transforming its tech landscape rather than being solely burdened by legacy issues. However, the scale of these initiatives suggests potential for large-scale projects and integration challenges inherent in such transformations:

- **Digital Transformation & AI Investment:** Marriott is implementing a multi-year digital transformation plan centered on AI and cloud technologies, including developing a cloud-native infrastructure. The company's strategy involves leveraging AI for efficiency, guest experience, and streamlining operations. They are prioritizing automation of high-cost processes and beta-launching new central reservation, property management, and loyalty systems.
- **Competitive Landscape:** Marriott CEO Anthony Capuano is focused on persuading travelers to plan trips directly on Marriott's platforms rather than through search engines or AI tools, highlighting competition in digital distribution.
- **Past Breaches and Compliance:** Improving cybersecurity is a key aspect of Marriott's strategy following a settlement with the Federal Trade Commission concerning past data breaches, which requires enhancing data privacy and security programs.

3 OPERATIONAL PAIN SIGNALS

While overall development and international growth remain strong, specific operational challenges have been identified:

- **Geographic Disparities:** International markets generally outperformed U.S. and Canada in RevPAR growth in late 2025 and early 2026. The Middle East conflict and airlift disruptions are noted as factors weighing on performance in EMEA and APAC in the Q1 2026 outlook. The operating environment in Greater China continues to be challenged by weak macroeconomic conditions and soft consumer sentiment.
- **Segment Weakness:** The Select Service segment experienced a RevPAR decline of 30 basis points in Q4 2025. Business Transient RevPAR was flat for the full year 2025 and declined 3% in Q4, significantly impacted by a drop in government RevPAR.
- **Owner Profitability Concerns:** Marriott is examining every aspect of how its hotels are developed and function, including loyalty program charge-out rates, technology platforms, and affiliation fees, to address diluted returns for hotel owners.

4 HIRING SIGNALS

Marriott has undertaken workforce adjustments and leadership changes, indicating a focus on optimizing its organizational structure and operations:

- **Layoffs and Restructuring:** Marriott International conducted layoffs in its customer engagement centers in October 2025 as part of a strategic review to better reflect how guests interact across channels. While described as a "very small subset" of the workforce, some reports indicated "significant layoffs" across various departments, with some attributing this to a move towards "more AI-driven solutions." Earlier, in late 2024/early 2025, Marriott implemented a company-wide restructuring that involved hundreds of corporate job cuts aimed at "reshaping the way we work," with plans to add new positions and transition affected employees into them. Marriott Vacations Worldwide also laid off 136 employees in August 2025 due to a new operating model.
- **Leadership Transition:** Marriott announced a significant leadership restructuring in January 2026, effective March 28, 2026, involving the retirement of two senior executives and the appointment of new regional leaders. The company's CFO, Leeny Oberg, also retired in early 2026.

5

TIMING TRIGGERS

Several key events and ongoing initiatives suggest ripe timing for new solutions and partnerships:

- **New Leadership:** The significant leadership restructuring effective March 28, 2026, with new regional presidents and a new CFO, could lead to shifts in strategic priorities and vendor relationships.
- **Announced Transformation:** Marriott is engaged in a multi-year digital transformation plan focusing on AI and cloud technologies, with beta launches of new core systems underway and a phased rollout planned over the next 18 months. An "enterprise transformation" role was also part of recent executive changes.
- **Regulatory Deadlines/Compliance:** The need to enhance data privacy and security programs following a settlement with the Federal Trade Commission creates a timing trigger for cybersecurity and compliance solutions.
- **Post-M&A Integration:** Marriott completed the integration of citizenM in 2025, a process that can often uncover opportunities for new systems or services.
- **Ongoing Cost Efficiency Drive:** The stated goal of achieving \$80-\$90 million in G&A cost reductions starting in 2025, and delivering savings to owners, indicates an active search for efficiency-driving solutions.



COMPETITIVE & VENDORS

Marriott International is undertaking a significant technological transformation, investing heavily in cloud-based systems, artificial intelligence (AI), and data platforms to enhance customer experience and operational efficiency. The company is a dominant player in the global hospitality market, competing primarily with Hilton, IHG, and Hyatt.

1. Current Technology Vendors

Marriott leverages a diverse technology stack to manage its extensive global operations:

- **ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning):** Marriott has utilized Oracle PeopleSoft ERP for its financial system since 2015, with Accenture involved in its implementation.
- **CRM (Customer Relationship Management):** The company employs a comprehensive CRM strategy, prominently featuring Salesforce CRM, including Service Cloud and Sales Cloud. Marriott's "Empower" platform, built on Salesforce, is used by over 100,000 associates across various teams. Other CRM tools mentioned include Oracle Siebel and MICROS OPERA PMS.
- **HCM (Human Capital Management):** Marriott launched Oracle Fusion Cloud Human Capital Management (HCM) in December 2020 to optimize HR processes and employee experiences. This is noted as one of the largest Oracle Cloud HCM deployments. Older systems like Kronos and SAP SuccessFactors are also referenced in relation to HR and payroll operations.
- **Cloud & Data Platforms:**
 - Marriott utilizes a multi-cloud architecture with Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) and Microsoft Azure.
 - Its data platform is hosted on Amazon Web Services (AWS), integrating batch and streaming data into cloud object storage. Marriott is also developing an AWS-backed Travel Assistant.
 - Snowflake serves as a key data warehouse, simplifying Marriott's data platform and improving performance and cost savings. Data consumption is often done through Tableau.
 - For its core IT systems and the Marriott Bonvoy platform, Marriott adopted IBM's public cloud computing platform around 2015.
 - The company is transitioning to modern, scalable, cloud-based systems with partners such as Amadeus and Agilisys.
 - Marriott implemented NICE CXone for its global customer service operations in March 2023, consolidating its tech stack.
- **Artificial Intelligence (AI):** Marriott is making substantial investments in AI, with planned expenditures of \$1 billion to \$1.2 billion in 2024. Key initiatives include an AI Incubator, an AI-powered virtual assistant named RenAI, and a generative AI search tool for vacation rentals. The company is piloting Microsoft 365 Copilot and using generative AI for SEO content generation, contact-center coaching, and trial trip-planning tools. Salesforce's AI-powered tools also aid in personalized upsell offers.

2. Known SI/Consulting Partners

Marriott collaborates with several prominent system integrators and consulting partners:

- **Accenture:** A long-standing partner, Accenture has worked with Marriott on various initiatives, including the implementation of its Oracle-based accounting platform and the creation of a global HR hub powered by Oracle Fusion Cloud HCM. Accenture also acquired Marriott Business Services (MBS) F&A unit to provide finance and accounting services under a 10-year contract and has partnered with Marriott on skill development programs in India.
- **Publicis Sapient:** This firm collaborated with Marriott on developing a natural language-based search tool for Homes & Villas by Marriott Bonvoy.
- **Oracle Customer Success Services:** Provides ongoing support and strategic guidance for Marriott's Oracle Cloud HCM implementation.
- **NiCE:** Partnered with Marriott for the successful implementation of the CXone platform for customer service.

3. Procurement Signals

Marriott's current activities indicate strong procurement signals in several technology areas:

- **Major Technology Investment & Replatforming:** Marriott plans to invest between \$1 billion and \$1.2 billion in technology in 2024, marking its highest tech expenditure to date, with a significant focus on AI. Since 2023, the company has invested \$1.8 billion in capital and technology, with an additional \$1.1 billion expected in 2026, largely allocated to replatforming its property

management, central reservation, and loyalty systems. This "worldwide technology transformation" is moving away from legacy systems to cloud-native platforms, with a phased rollout anticipated throughout 2026.

- **Cloud & AI Adoption:** The company is actively pursuing cloud migration and modernization, aiming to leverage cloud capabilities for agility, innovation, and cost savings. Its focus on AI is evident through its AI Incubator, various AI-powered tools in development, and pilots of generative AI applications like Microsoft 365 Copilot.
- **HCM Integration Modernization:** Marriott has modernized its HCM integration architecture by replacing over 70 point-to-point integrations with a centralized, event-driven framework built on Oracle Integration Cloud and an Autonomous Transaction Processing database. This indicates a push for more efficient and scalable data distribution.
- **Ongoing Salesforce Development:** Job postings for "Senior Software Engineer, Salesforce Platforms" and "Director, Salesforce Platforms" highlight Marriott's continued investment in developing and supporting its extensive Salesforce ecosystem, including Salesforce Service Cloud and Sales Cloud platforms. These roles emphasize expertise in Salesforce administration, development, Lightning framework, Apex, Java, and integration with AWS, along with experience in DevOps tools like Git, JIRA, Jenkins, and Dynatrace.

4. Competitive Dynamics

Marriott operates in a highly competitive global hospitality market, with key rivals including:

- **Top Competitors:** Hilton Worldwide Holdings, InterContinental Hotels Group (IHG), and Hyatt Hotels Corporation are consistently identified as Marriott's primary competitors. Choice Hotels is also noted as a significant player, particularly in the midscale segment.
- **Market Position and Share:**
- **Marriott International** is the world's largest hotel company, leading in scale with over 9,500 properties and more than 30 brands across 141 countries and territories as of early 2025.
- **Hilton** ranks second with over 8,600 properties, while **IHG** has over 6,600 properties, dominating the midscale market. **Hyatt** is smaller, with around 1,350 properties, but strong in luxury and lifestyle segments.
- **Marriott's Bonvoy** loyalty program is the largest in the world, with over 237 million members, and members account for approximately 50% of total sold room nights, providing a significant competitive advantage. Around 70% of Marriott's room nights are booked by loyalty members, positioning it strongly against Online Travel Agencies (OTAs).
- **Gaining or Losing Market Share:**
- **Marriott** is actively focused on growth in luxury and all-inclusive segments, leveraging its extensive global distribution and loyalty program to maintain dominance.
- The company has a substantial pipeline of new rooms (620,500 rooms in construction or contract), with a focus on new mid-scale and extended-stay brands, indicating continued expansion.
- **Marriott's** business model, heavily reliant on management contracts, results in a gross margin 20% higher than **Hilton's**, suggesting greater value extraction per property despite a potentially slower growth rate compared to **Hilton's** franchise-heavy model.
- **Marriott's** revenue reached \$25.10 billion in 2024. While **Marriott** shows strength in asset efficiency and diversification, it faces challenges with equity returns and liquidity.
- The overall hospitality market experienced significant growth, reaching \$1.5 trillion worldwide in 2023, suggesting a favorable environment for major players like **Marriott** and **Hilton**, whose asset-light models and strong loyalty programs contribute to widening their competitive moats.

SALES PLAY

1. RECOMMENDED PITCH ANGLE

AI-Enabled Transformation Play

Marriott is in year two of a multi-billion dollar technology replatforming initiative (Project Catalyst) specifically designed to create an AI-ready ecosystem. With \$1.1 billion allocated for 2026 (35% to digital transformation), CTO Naveen Manga has explicitly stated that 2026 is "a year for scale" for AI, moving from pilots to production. The company is building an "agentic mesh" shared intelligence layer and deploying cloud-native property management, central reservations, and loyalty systems across a meaningful number of hotels in 2026. This creates immediate urgency for solutions that accelerate AI adoption, ensure clean unified data for AI models (addressing Drew Pinto's stated belief that "technology problems are actually data problems"), or integrate with their new cloud-native architecture during active deployment rather than post-implementation.

2. CONVERSATION OPENER QUESTIONS

- You're rolling out Project Catalyst's replatformed property management and loyalty systems to a meaningful number of hotels in 2026. As you move these cloud-native platforms from development into production deployment, what's proving most challenging about ensuring data quality and consistency across properties to support the agentic mesh you're building?
- Naveen mentioned 2026 is the year to scale AI beyond pilots. You're exploring agentic booking with Google AI Mode and natural language search with OpenAI, but also building internal AI capabilities for labor scheduling and supply chain optimization. Where are you finding the biggest gap between the AI use cases you want to deploy and the data infrastructure readiness to support them?
- With the new regional leadership structure effective March 28th—consolidating US, Canada, and CALA under Satya Anand—and Jen Mason stepping into the CFO role April 1st, how is the technology roadmap being re-prioritized to support this unified regional operating model and the stated \$80-90 million G&A cost reduction target?
- You've selected specific vendors like Agilysys for PMS and Shiji for POS, but you're building proprietary systems for your agentic mesh and AI chassis. How are you drawing the line between what you build internally for competitive differentiation versus what you integrate from best-of-breed vendors, especially as you scale AI in 2026?
- The India expansion achieved 75 hotel signings in six months through Series by Marriott, adding 3,556 rooms across 43 cities. As you target 250 operating hotels and 50,000 rooms in India by 2030, how are you ensuring your replatformed technology systems can scale to support this rapid tier 2 and tier 3 market expansion with the same level of guest experience and operational efficiency?

3. LANDMINES TO AVOID

- Do not position as a replacement for their massive ongoing investment in Project Catalyst or suggest their current replatforming approach is wrong. They have committed \$1.8 billion since 2023 with another \$1.1 billion in 2026 and are in active deployment. Frame as acceleration, augmentation, or de-risking of their existing transformation, not a course correction.
- Avoid generic cybersecurity pitches or referencing the past data breaches as a primary pain point without extreme sensitivity. While they settled with the FTC and are enhancing security programs, leading with "we heard about your breach problem" will immediately create defensiveness with new leadership trying to move forward.
- Do not ignore or dismiss their existing vendor relationships, especially recently selected partners like Agilysys, Shiji, SevenRooms, NICE CXone, Snowflake, and AWS. They made deliberate choices in 2023-2025. Position around integration with, enhancement of, or complementary capabilities to these platforms rather than replacement.
- Avoid speaking about the hospitality industry generically or treating Marriott like a typical hotel chain. They are the world's largest hotel company with 30+ brands, 9,500+ properties across 141 countries, and 237+ million Bonvoy members. They view themselves as a technology and loyalty platform company that happens to operate in hospitality. Speak to their scale, complexity, and platform ambitions.

4. SUGGESTED NEXT STEP

Request a 30-minute discovery call specifically with representatives from both the Global Technology organization (reporting to CTO Naveen Manga) and the Revenue and Technology team (under Drew Pinto, EVP and Chief Revenue and Technology Officer) to map your solution's integration points with their Project Catalyst rollout timeline.

Frame the objective as: "We'd like to understand your current deployment sequencing for the replatformed property management, central reservations, and loyalty systems across your hotel portfolio in 2026, and share how [your solution] has helped similar enterprise-scale deployments de-risk AI readiness, accelerate data unification, or reduce integration complexity during active cloud migration—with the goal of determining if there's a logical pilot opportunity within your 2026 deployment wave."

Offer to sign an NDA if needed to discuss their specific deployment architecture and timeline details, signaling you understand the strategic sensitivity of their transformation program.

5. BEST ENTRY POINT

Role: Senior Director or VP-level leader within the Global Technology organization responsible for AI platform development, data infrastructure, or cloud platform architecture—specifically someone involved in the deployment execution of Project Catalyst reporting into CTO Naveen Manga.

Person: The specific individual is not named in available research, but the role would carry titles such as "Vice President, AI and Data Platforms," "Senior Director, Cloud Architecture and Engineering," or "Vice President, Enterprise Technology Transformation."

This person sits below Naveen Manga (Global CTO) but above individual Salesforce platform engineers or application developers. They would have direct accountability for building the "agentic mesh" shared intelligence layer, ensuring unified guest data across replatformed systems, and translating the CTO's "year for scale" AI directive into actual production deployments across Marriott's 9,500+ properties during 2026.

Alternative secondary entry: Drew Pinto (Executive Vice President and Chief Revenue and Technology Officer), who has publicly stated that technology problems are actually data problems and that Marriott's built technology will "unlock the full potential of AI." He owns the business outcome side of the technology transformation and would be receptive to solutions that accelerate revenue-generating AI applications, particularly around booking, guest experience, and loyalty.

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